

Operations

Question Booklet

Past HSC and trial questions from your Drive, screenshotted exactly as they appeared in the original papers.

SECTION	QUESTIONS			
Section A — Multiple choice	Q1–18	18 questions	18 marks	p. 2
Section B — Short answer	Q19–45	27 questions	89 marks	p. 9
Section C — 20-mark questions	Q46–47	2 questions	40 marks	p. 26

How to use this booklet

1. **Section A** – multiple choice: circle one answer (about 1.5 min each).
2. **Section B** – short answers. Each question shows the paper it came from and its marks, and has the same number of writing lines as the original paper (about 1.8 min per mark).
3. **Section C** – the 20-mark questions are on the last pages: plan in the box, then write in full on separate paper.
4. Check your answers in the matching **Answer Booklet** – question numbers are identical.

Section A — Multiple choice

Circle the best answer. About 1.5 minutes each.

Q1 2019 HSC · Q11

- 11 A sole-trader cleaning business purchases generic products to lower costs and be price competitive.

This is an example of which strategy?

- A. Cost leadership
 - B. Economies of scale
 - C. Inventory management
 - D. Goods and service differentiation
-

Q2 Roseville Trial 2023 · Q8

- 8 Goods and services have different characteristics and features.

Which of the following combinations of attributes is correct?

	<i>Goods</i>	<i>Services</i>
(A)	Tangible	Intangible
(B)	Have physical inputs	Need be stored in a warehouse
(C)	Often stored in warehouses	Tangible
(D)	Intangible	Perishable

Q3 2022 HSC · Q10

- 10 A printing business uses chemicals in its production process.

Which of the following factors has a legal regulation that affects the operations management of this business?

- A. Superannuation
 - B. Code of conduct
 - C. Union membership
 - D. Environmental protection
-

Q4 2021 HSC · Q12

- 12 A manager at a fast-food business wants to change the operations process in response to the influence of corporate social responsibility.

Which action would achieve this objective?

- A. Providing cash donations to a local hospital
 - B. Increasing the visibility of the cooking process
 - C. Offering a wider variety of healthy options on their menu
 - D. Ensuring that injured workers receive access to compensation payments
-

Q5 Newington Trial 2023 · Q5

5. Which of the following are both transformed resources for a fast-food restaurant?

- A. Grill and cash register
 - B. Cook and cooking utensils
 - C. Tables and chairs
 - D. Hamburgers and soft drink
-

Q6 Roseville Trial 2024 · Q9

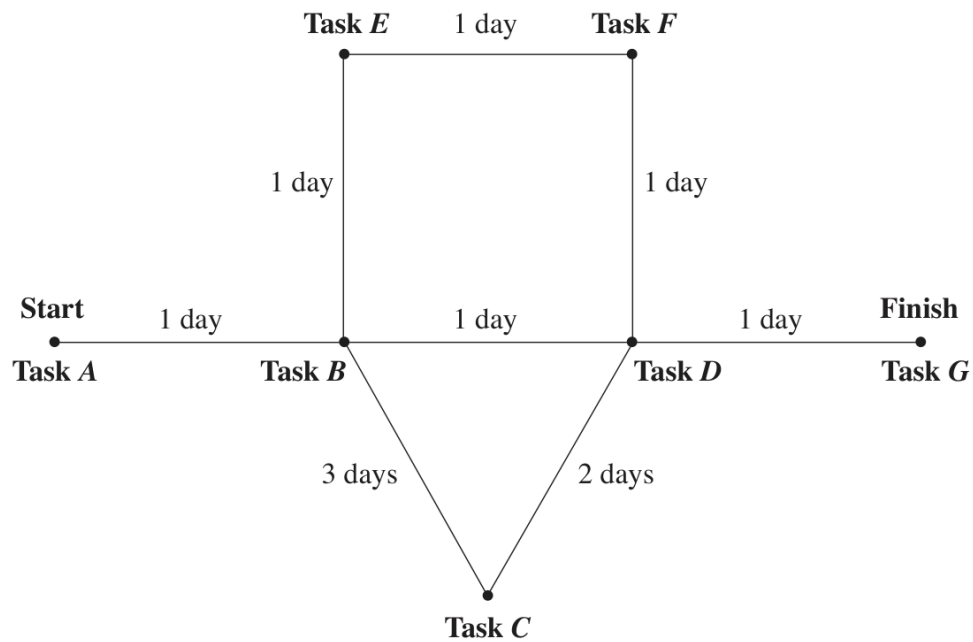
- 9 A bakery produces a range of baked goods, including bread, cakes, and pastries. They have a visible production area where customers can watch the baking process, which is a key part of their operations strategy.

Which of the following best describes the visibility aspect of the 4 Vs of operations in this bakery?

Visibility refers to the:

- (A) large quantities of bread produced daily.
 - (B) seasonal demand changes for different baked goods.
 - (C) different types of baked goods offered, such as bread, cakes, and pastries.
 - (D) fact that customers can directly observe the baking process.
-

Use the following critical path diagram to answer Questions 19 and 20.

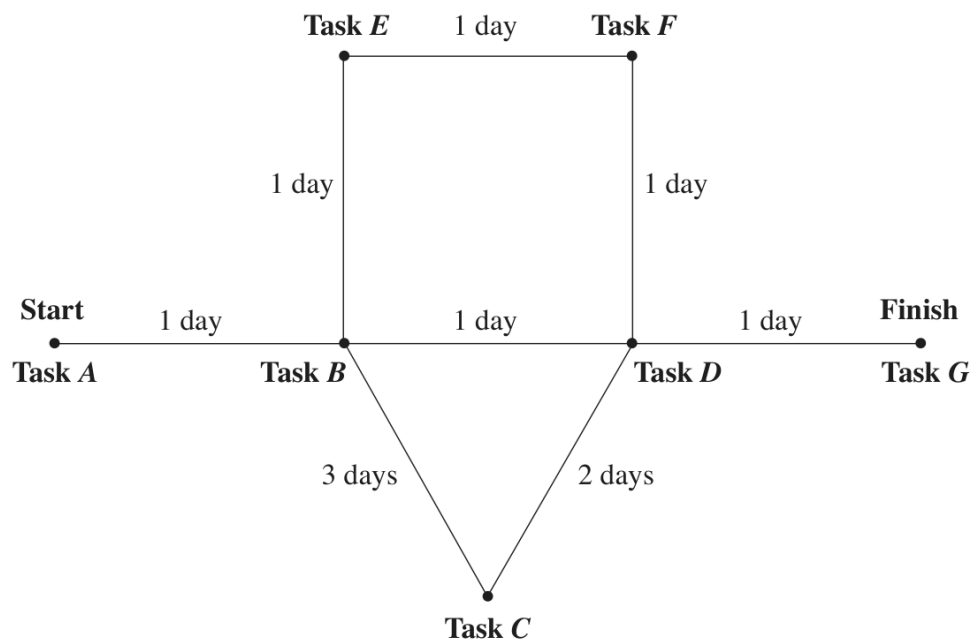


19 Which tasks need to be completed prior to completing Task D?

- A. A, B only
- B. A, B, C only
- C. A, B, E, F only
- D. A, B, C, E, F only

Q8 2019 HSC · Q20

Use the following critical path diagram to answer Questions 19 and 20.



- 20** An improvement in technology reduces the time between Task C and Task D to one day.

What is the new length of the critical path?

- A. 3 days
- B. 5 days
- C. 6 days
- D. 10 days

Q9 Abbotsleigh Trial 2024 · Q9

9. After comparing monthly data on defects, an operations manager makes changes to the production line to improve efficiency and dependability.

Which operations process is being implemented by the manager?

- a) Sequencing and scheduling
- b) Monitoring
- c) Controlling
- d) Critical Path Analysis

Q10 2021 HSC · Q14

- 14** A car manufacturer's marketing manager suggests to the operations manager that they increase the warranty period from 3 to 5 years in order to increase market share.

The operations manager would agree to this suggestion if

- A. gearing has reduced.
 - B. it provided an incentive to increase production speed.
 - C. current quality management strategies could support it.
 - D. it provided sales staff the opportunity to increase sales commissions.
-

Q11 2023 HSC · Q2

- 2** A florist designs floral displays for weddings to suit the colour preferences of individual couples.

Which of the following would be the main performance objective being targeted by this florist?

- A. Customisation
 - B. Flexibility
 - C. Quality
 - D. Speed
-

Q12 2022 HSC · Q7

- 7** A large clothing manufacturer in NSW wants to reduce input costs.

Which strategy would achieve this objective?

- A. Increasing product variety
 - B. Increasing employee training
 - C. Implementing global sourcing
 - D. Implementing sustainable packaging
-

Q13 Abbotsleigh Trial 2024 · Q13

13. Which of the following are both an advantage and disadvantage of a business outsourcing an operations function?

	<i>Advantage</i>	<i>Disadvantage</i>
a)	Access to skilled labour and resources not attained by the business	Decreased costs of production
b)	Increased vulnerability to the external business environment	Economies of scale
c)	Loss of control of the production process	Increased costs of production
d)	Efficiency and cost savings	Communication and language barriers

Q14 2021 HSC · Q3

3 Which row of the table shows both an advantage and a disadvantage of a business investing in leading edge technology?

	<i>Advantage</i>	<i>Disadvantage</i>
A.	Higher quality output	High initial investment
B.	Proven effectiveness	Increased waste
C.	Widely accepted and used	High initial investment
D.	Increased speed	Increased waste

Q15 Abbotsleigh Trial 2024 · Q5

5. *Henry Electronics Pty Ltd* has a stock valuation policy which records the business's newest stock as the first stock sold.

Which of the following is the inventory management strategy implemented by the business?

- a) LIFO
- b) JIT
- c) Value Added
- d) FIFO

Q16 Knox Trial 2023 · Q17

17 What is the impact of moving to a just-in-time (JIT) inventory management system?

	Holding costs	Logistics costs	Risk of stock outage
A.	Lower	Higher	Higher
B.	Same	Higher	Lower
C.	Higher	Lower	Same
D.	Lower	Lower	Lower

Q17 2019 HSC · Q9

9 A business reduces product defects by using inspections in the production process.

This is an example of quality

- A. control.
- B. improvement.
- C. innovation.
- D. production.

Q18 2020 HSC · Q13

13 In order to achieve best practice, a mobile phone company examines global trends in phone technology before designing and producing their phones.

What operations strategy is this business using?

- A. Standardisation
- B. Global sourcing
- C. Scanning and learning
- D. Inventory management

Section B — Short answer

Write your answer on the lines. Aim for about 1.8 minutes per mark.

Q19 2020 HSC · Question 23 (a)

4 marks

A denim jeans clothing store is concerned about declining sales. They have identified that the lower sales are a result of:

- outdated store presentation
- increased foreign competition
- a reluctance to adopt modern in-store payment methods.

(a) How could the strategic role of operations management assist this business?

4

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Precision Shave produces and sells a collection of eco-friendly razors made from sustainable materials. The business is also introducing a subscription service that delivers customised shaving kits catering to the specific needs of individual consumers.

b) Explain the interdependence of operations and marketing for this business.

(3 marks)

A denim jeans clothing store is concerned about declining sales. They have identified that the lower sales are a result of:

- outdated store presentation
- increased foreign competition
- a reluctance to adopt modern in-store payment methods.

(b) Analyse operations strategies that could be used to address TWO operations influences affecting this business.

6

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Use the following information to answer the questions below.

Rebecca owns and operates a health food business. Due to an increase in competition from large retail chains, she needs to revise her operational strategies. A problem that her customers have identified is products that are consistently 'out of stock', as well as damaged goods in need of replacing.

- (c) Outline how quality expectations could impact this business

2

- (b) A market leading business manufactures electronics.

4

Explain how environmental sustainability can influence the operations of this business.

Q24 Barker Trial 2024 · Question 22 (a)**2 marks**

- (a) Distinguish between legal compliance and corporate social responsibility.

2

Q25 2019 HSC · Question 24 (c)**4 marks**

A juice bar is operating in a shopping centre. The juice is served to customers in plastic cups with plastic straws. The high sales volume and quick turnover demand an efficient operations process.

- (c) Why might this business be reluctant to become more socially responsible?

4

Q26 2019 HSC · Question 24 (a)**2 marks**

A juice bar is operating in a shopping centre. The juice is served to customers in plastic cups with plastic straws. The high sales volume and quick turnover demand an efficient operations process.

- (a) Identify TWO transforming resources used in this business.

2

Q27 2021 HSC · Question 21 (a)

2 marks

A building company has been contracted to build a new home for a customer. The contract requires the home to be completed within six months and within budget.

- (a) Outline how this customer can be considered an input in the construction of the new home. **2**

Q28 2019 HSC · Question 24 (b)

4 marks

A juice bar is operating in a shopping centre. The juice is served to customers in plastic cups with plastic straws. The high sales volume and quick turnover demand an efficient operations process.

- (b) How does variety impact the transformation process of this business? **4**

A car retailer expects high demand and orders extra stock of the latest release lower priced, electric car. The car retailer also provides longer warranties than competitors as well as car repairs and services.

- (d) Discuss the impact of variety and visibility on the transformation process of the car retailer. 4

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

A building company has been contracted to build a new home for a customer. The contract requires the home to be completed within six months and within budget.

- (b) How could a Gantt chart help the building company meet the terms of the contract? **4**

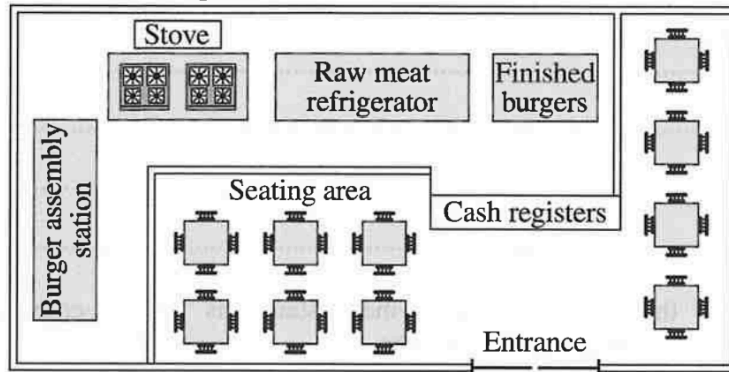
- (c) Explain how Gantt charts and critical path analysis can be used to improve business operations. **4**

Michael would like to open a new burger restaurant.

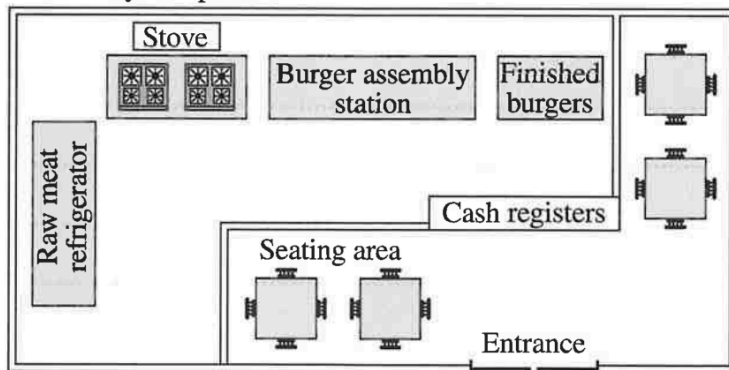
- (c) Michael is considering which process layout would be the most efficient for this restaurant.

4

Process layout option 1



Process layout option 2



Compare each layout in terms of efficiency and profitability.

[illegible]

Q33 Barker Trial 2023 · Question 21 (c)

2 marks

- (c) Outline the purpose of task design.

2

Q34 Reddam Trial 2023 · Question 21 (c)

2 marks

A car retailer expects high demand and orders extra stock of the latest release lower priced, electric car. The car retailer also provides longer warranties than competitors as well as car repairs and services.

- (c) Why may this business exceed its legal obligations when offering warranties to customers?

2

Michael would like to open a new burger restaurant.

2

- (a) Outline a performance objective relevant to this business.

A leading sports shoe manufacturer enables customers to design their own shoes. This has required the business to purchase an additional factory and machinery.

- (b) Explain ONE possible conflict that may arise between achieving TWO performance objectives for the sports shoe manufacturer. **2**

- (b) A business has decided to expand its product range. Discuss the operational strategy of new product or service design and development for this business **4**

Sushi Train is a successful global Japanese fast food company that has been rapidly expanding in Australia. Customers have been attracted to their unique process layout, which sees little plates of sushi rotate around via a train style system. Customers take their meals directly from the train and get to watch their meals produced in front of their eyes.

- (d) Explain how the operations strategies of global sourcing and economies of scale might be beneficial to this business. **4**

A building company has been contracted to build a new home for a customer. The contract requires the home to be completed within six months and within budget.

The operations manager will need to outsource certain elements of the construction process.

- (c) Explain TWO quality management strategies that could be used to ensure the quality of the outsourced work. **4**

Use the following information to answer questions 22 (b) and (c).

Focus Frames produces eyewear such as sunglasses and prescription glasses using an automated assembly line that is run by a combination of staff and robotics.

They are seeking to improve the speed and efficiency of their manufacturing process.

- (c) Analyse the implementation of technology in achieving operations objectives for this business.

5

Michael would like to open a new burger restaurant.

- (b) Recommend an appropriate inventory management strategy for this business.

3

A car retailer expects high demand and orders extra stock of the latest release lower priced, electric car. The car retailer also provides longer warranties than competitors as well as car repairs and services.

- (b) Describe ONE disadvantage of holding stock for the car retailer.

2

An Australian tyre manufacturer is expanding its business. In order to reduce operating costs and increase sales and profit, rubber will be sourced from the global market.

The business wants to:

- maintain quality outputs
- achieve economies of scale.

- (a) Outline ONE potential issue this business could face in relation to both cost and quality of outputs. **2**

An Australian tyre manufacturer is expanding its business. In order to reduce operating costs and increase sales and profit, rubber will be sourced from the global market.

The business wants to:

- maintain quality outputs
- achieve economies of scale.

- (b) Explain the benefits of achieving economies of scale for both the business and consumers. **3**

Section C — 20-mark questions

A business report and an essay. Plan in the box, then write on separate paper (about 35 minutes each).

Q46 2021 HSC · Question 25

20 marks

Ozzi Baby Food Pty Ltd have developed a trusted reputation in domestic and global markets due to their safe and sustainably-sourced product range. This has led to a significant increase in demand. As a result, they are considering the purchase of a larger automated factory. This will lead to some job losses. The business will require external finance to fund the factory purchase using either a mortgage or becoming a public company on the Australian Securities Exchange (ASX).

You have been hired as a consultant by Ozzi Baby Food Pty Ltd to write a business report to the owners. In your report:

- outline TWO operations influences affecting this business
- discuss the use of retraining and redundancy payments to help overcome employee resistance to these changes
- compare the use of a mortgage to a new issue of shares to fund the factory purchase.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

Analyse the relationship between performance objectives and operations strategies.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.